

HMF Design Clinic

Team Workbook

Cedarline Health Group · 4 use cases · 400 points

YOUR TEAM

Team name: _____

Members: _____

Members (cont.): _____

Date: _____

How this workbook works

- You're a team of Cisco Solution Engineers helping Cedarline Health Group. Read their situation (next page), then work the four use cases in order.
- For every customer concern, fill two answer boxes: the **product / platform** that solves it, and the **Solution Engineer response** — how it addresses the concern and how it helps Cedarline.
- Hand your workbook to the proctor. Each use case is scored out of 100 — four use cases make 400.

Your four use cases

- ☐ **1 AI Security** — Detection & unknown threats
- ☐ **2 Cloud Edge** — Multicloud posture
- ☐ **3 DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall** — Estate complexity
- ☐ **4 Macro & Micro Segmentation** — East-west control

READ FIRST

The customer — Cedarline Health Group

A regional healthcare payer-provider: ~8,000 staff across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business. It grew by acquisition — a second data centre was absorbed as-is two years ago — and is mid-flight into public cloud. After a March security incident the board asked what would have stopped it, and leadership still can't answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but temporary.

THEIR ENVIRONMENT AT A GLANCE

- **Campus & clinics** — four hospitals, 31 clinics, billing workstations, remote staff on VPN. TLS is mandated everywhere, so most traffic is encrypted.
- **Two data centres** — DC-1 (owned) is effectively flat: any workload reaches almost any other. DC-2 (acquired) came with an inherited rulebase nobody can prove. Three firewall consoles; two engineers hold all the knowledge.
- **Three public clouds** — AWS (claims analytics), Azure (patient portal), GCP (data science): three teams, three policy models. Nobody can report posture across all three.

TIP Name a **product**, not a category. Make your reasoning turn on something Cedarline actually said — that's what scores highest.

1

USE CASE 1 OF 4 · DETECTION & UNKNOWN THREATS

AI Security

Why this matters. March proved signatures aren't enough — and most of the network is a blind spot because it's encrypted.

TIP Detect **without decrypting** — Compliance has banned decrypting clinical traffic. Name that in your answer.

Concern 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough." Four days of dwell time, and nothing to match.

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

Concern 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We mandated TLS everywhere, so most of our traffic is encrypted and we've lost visibility. Broadly decrypting clinical traffic is a compliance non-starter."

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

Use Case 1 of 4 · next: Cloud Edge

Cloud Edge

Why this matters. Growth lives in the cloud — but it's three clouds, three teams, three policy models, and no single view.

TIP One policy model across all three clouds beats three separate ones. Who can finally report posture across AWS, Azure AND GCP?

Concern 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're deploying across AWS, Azure and GCP, but each cloud has its own constructs and workflows. A policy that means one thing in AWS means something subtly different in Azure."

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

Concern 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Nobody can tell us our security posture across all three clouds."

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

Use Case 2 of 4 · next: DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

3

USE CASE 3 OF 4 · ESTATE COMPLEXITY

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

Why this matters. Three consoles, a weeks-long backlog, an inherited rulebase nobody can prove — and only two people who understand it.

TIP Two engineers run everything. Favour consolidation and automation — anything they can't operate on Monday won't stick.

Concern 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually — mixed vendor, three consoles, a change backlog measured in weeks."

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

Concern 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We inherited DC-2's rulebase and nobody can prove what a rule does, so nobody deletes one. Two engineers hold all the knowledge."

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

Use Case 3 of 4 · next: Macro & Micro Segmentation

4

USE CASE 4 OF 4 · EAST-WEST CONTROL

Macro & Micro Segmentation

Why this matters. The data centre is wide open inside, and segmentation has died three times on ten thousand hand-written rules.

TIP They failed 3× on hand-written rules — so **automation** is the story. How do you segment without writing 10,000 rules by hand?

Concern 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

“We don’t feel we have enough control over east-west movement inside the data centre — any workload can reach almost any other.”

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

Concern 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

“Once an attacker gets in, they can move laterally across applications. Enforcing segmentation meant writing ~10,000 rules by hand — so it never happened.”

Product / platform

Which Cisco product / platform solves this? Name it specifically.

Solution Engineer response

Explain it in two moves — keep it specific to Cedarline.

HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN

HOW IT HELPS CEDARLINE

PROCTOR — SCORE

 / 100

Notes

Use Case 4 of 4 · last one — finish strong!

FINISH

Your scoreboard

#	Use case	Score
1	AI Security (Detection & unknown threats)	_____ / 100
2	Cloud Edge (Multicloud posture)	_____ / 100
3	DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall (Estate complexity)	_____ / 100
4	Macro & Micro Segmentation (East-west control)	_____ / 100
TOTAL		_____ / 400

Well played. You turned a pile of problems into a plan — the way a great SE does in the real room.

Cisco Secure · HMF Design Clinic · Cedarline Health Group is fictional